

Daily Windows 11 Usage vs Linux CLI

Learn Linux Like a Windows User

This guide maps normal daily Windows 11 GUI activities to Linux terminal commands.

1. Open File Explorer

Windows 11 GUI	Linux CLI
Open File Explorer	<code>ls</code>
View files/folders	<code>ls</code>
Detailed view	<code>ls -l</code>
Hidden files	<code>ls -la</code>

Linux Example

```
ls
ls -l
ls -la
```

2. Open a Folder

Windows Action	Linux Command
Double click folder	<code>cd foldername</code>

Example

```
cd Documents
```

3. Go Back

Windows Action	Linux Command
Back button	<code>cd ..</code>

Example

```
cd ..
```

4. Go to Desktop

Windows Action	Linux Command
Open Desktop	<code>cd ~/Desktop</code>

Example

```
cd ~/Desktop
```

5. Check Current Location

Windows GUI	Linux CLI
Address bar	<code>pwd</code>

Example

```
pwd
```

Meaning:

```
Print Working Directory
```

6. Create New Folder

Windows Action	Linux Command
Right Click → New Folder	<code>mkdir foldername</code>

Example

```
mkdir test
```

7. Create File

Windows Action	Linux Command
New Text File	<code>touch file.txt</code>

Example

```
touch test.txt
```

8. Rename File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Right Click → Rename	<code>mv old new</code>

Example

```
mv old.txt new.txt
```

9. Move File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Cut → Paste	<code>mv file /path</code>

Example

```
mv file.txt /tmp/
```

10. Copy File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Copy → Paste	<code>cp source destination</code>

Example

```
cp file.txt backup.txt
```

11. Delete File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Delete Key	<code>rm file.txt</code>
Delete Folder	<code>rm -rf folder</code>

Example

```
rm file.txt  
rm -rf testfolder
```

12. Open File Content

Windows Action	Linux Command
Open text file	<code>cat file.txt</code>
Read large file	<code>less file.txt</code>

Example

```
cat app.log  
less app.log
```

13. Edit File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Open Notepad	<code>nano file.txt</code>
Advanced Editor	<code>vim file.txt</code>

Example

```
nano config.txt
```

14. Search File

Windows Action	Linux Command
Explorer Search	<code>find / -name file.txt</code>

Example

```
find / -name app.log
```

15. Search Text Inside Files

Windows Action	Linux Command
Search inside logs	<code>grep "text" file</code>

Example

```
grep "error" app.log
```

Recursive Search:

```
grep -r "nginx" /etc/
```

16. Open Task Manager

Windows Action	Linux Command
Ctrl+Shift+Esc	<code>top</code>
Advanced Task Manager	<code>htop</code>

Example

```
top  
htop
```

17. End Process

Windows Action	Linux Command
End Task	<code>kill -9 PID</code>

Example

First check process:

```
ps aux
```

Kill process:

```
kill -9 1234
```

18. Check IP Address

Windows	Linux
<code>ipconfig</code>	<code>ip a</code>

Example

```
ip a
```

19. Ping Internet

Windows	Linux
<code>ping google.com</code>	<code>ping google.com</code>

Example

```
ping google.com
```

20. Install Software

Windows	Linux
Download .exe	<code>apt install</code>

Example

```
sudo apt update  
sudo apt install nginx
```

21. Run as Administrator

Windows	Linux
Run as Administrator	<code>sudo</code>

Example

```
sudo apt install docker.io
```

22. Restart Service

Windows	Linux
services.msc	<code>systemctl restart</code>

Example

```
systemctl restart nginx  
systemctl status nginx
```

23. View Logs

Windows	Linux
Event Viewer	<code>journalctl</code>
Live logs	<code>tail -f</code>

Example

```
journalctl  
tail -f app.log
```

24. Remote Login

Windows	Linux
RDP	<code>ssh</code>

Example

```
ssh ubuntu@192.168.1.10
```

25. Download File

Windows	Linux
Browser download	<code>wget</code>
PowerShell download	<code>curl -O</code>

Example

```
wget https://example.com/file.zip
```

26. Open Browser

Windows	Linux
Double click Chrome	<code>firefox</code>

Windows	Linux
Open browser	<code>google-chrome</code>

Example

```
firefox
```

27. Shutdown / Restart

Windows	Linux
Shutdown	<code>shutdown now</code>
Restart	<code>reboot</code>

Example

```
shutdown now
reboot
```

28. Windows Thinking vs Linux Thinking

Windows User

```
Mouse
→ Explorer
→ GUI
→ Click operations
```

Linux User

```
Terminal
→ Commands
→ Automation
→ Fast operations
```

29. Most Used Linux Commands Daily

```
ls
cd
pwd
mkdir
touch
cp
mv
rm
cat
nano
ps aux
top
htop
kill
ip a
ping
grep
find
sudo
systemctl
journalctl
tail -f
ssh
```

30. Final Easy Mapping

Windows Usage	Linux Command
Open folder	cd
View files	ls
Current location	pwd
Create folder	mkdir
Create file	touch
Rename file	mv
Copy file	cp
Delete file	rm
Open file	cat
Edit file	nano

Windows Usage	Linux Command
Task Manager	<code>top</code>
Kill app	<code>kill</code>
Check IP	<code>ip a</code>
Install software	<code>apt install</code>
Admin mode	<code>sudo</code>
Restart service	<code>systemctl restart</code>
Remote login	<code>ssh</code>